



Epson Stylus Photo 900

Fast forward

When it comes to printing speed, the Epson Photo 900 beats both the HP and the Canon hands down. This goes for both text as well as images. And in print quality, the Epson is at par with Canon's i905D, in terms of text—you can clearly see jagged edges and smudging.



Combi-documents with many colours are vivid and crisp, thanks to the six colour cartridges. The Epson 900 is good at reproducing details, but tonal balance goes for a complete toss. There's too much contrast in photos, which therefore seem too dark. A black printout will cost you Rs 4.60, whereas a colour page is Rs 3.

This printer's six colours are packed in two cartridges. Unlike the other two products in this category, the Epson 900 is not a true photo printer. You can't connect a digicam directly, nor does it have a multi-memory card reader. However, there are quite a few handy features, such as the CD-face printing tray. There's also an attachment for paper rolls.

The printer is bulky for its features; also, the input paper tray is an external attachment rather than an extendable one. The buttons are on the front, which makes them less accessible.

At Rs 14,495, the Epson Stylus Photo 900 is no match for HP's Photosmart 7960, which is Rs 3,000 more, but turns up results better on every front.

- + Relatively inexpensive
- Average-quality printouts

Epson Stylus Photo 900		A
Performance	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮	
Features	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮	
Build quality	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮	
Value for money	▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮ ▮	

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HP Photosmart 7960

Picture perfect

The HP Photosmart 7960 is a fire-cracker when it comes to text printout, and leaves the competitors biting the dust. But despite the mammoth 16 MB of internal memory, the printer is slower than the Canon and Epson models. However, the marginal difference does tilt in favour of the HP 7960, because of the quality aspect.



Printout quality is really good, whether it's text or images. The photograph we printed was reproduced without loss of details; moreover, the tonal balance was perfect, with true skin tones.

A black printout costs Rs 3, and a colour printout Rs 2.50—quite reasonable considering the quality. There are more colour cartridges with additional shades, so photos are more vivid, with great contrast.

The HP 7960 has a memory card reader that allows you to plug in almost any type of compact storage device. Also, if you have an HP digital camera, you can print directly from the camera. The printer uses three cartridges—two are regular cartridges, and the third is the

